a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

How to Run This Year

Routines, pacing, FAQ, and the calibration of Cash's voice.

Grade 10 year theme — Ownership, Money, and Compliance.
The 9-12 band is built for the adults who will scrutinize: parents, teachers, administrators.

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Grade 10 · Teacher Guide · the magazine version of the master document, set for adults to read end-to-end.

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GRADE 10 · TEACHER GUIDE

How to Run This

The legal, financial, and operational chassis under every venture.

10

For: high-school classroom teachers (typically business/CTE, social studies, ELA, or a dedicated entrepreneurship/personal-finance period), homeschool parents teaching the curriculum, and after-school program leads. **Companion to:** Grade 10 Curriculum Book, Lesson Plans, Student Activity Book, Cash Video Scripts, and Parent Guide.

WITH CASH - 9-12 VOICE

"Most adults skip this step. You won't."

How this year is built (and why)

> "Which people, and how do you know?"
>
> - CASH, GRADE 10

Grade 10 of Cash to Company centers one concrete thing: a Structured Venture Brief each student carries from September to June. The year teaches four moves on that brief — categorize the venture, compare funding sources, structure ownership and brand, premortem and map compliance — and each move is anchored in evidence and reasoning, not opinion.

The pedagogical bones come from three traditions:

- **Understanding by Design.** Big ideas, essential questions, and a year-end performance task drive the planning. Lessons feed the Capstone, not the other way around.
- **Workshop model.** Mini-lesson (10–15 min) → guided work (25–35 min) → confer + close (10 min). Students do most of their thinking on their own work most days.
- **Routines, not heroics.** The classroom runs on a small set of weekly routines — a Monday opener, a long Wednesday/Thursday work block, a Friday share-out — so cognitive heavy-lifting goes to the content, not the structure.

This is the year the curriculum picks up direct legal and financial vocabulary. That's both the pedagogical gift and the trap. The gift: students get the literacy that lets them read a real venture's structure. The trap: every adult in their life has opinions about LLCs, loans, and family money. Your job is to teach the categories and tradeoffs without ever telling a student what they should do for their actual life. The line we hold all year: "This is educational. For a real venture, consult a real attorney and a real accountant."

Classroom routines

These run all year. Establish them in the first three weeks and protect them.

Monday — Cash + the Question

A 5-minute Cash video (or printed transcript if no projector) introduces the week's question. Students respond to a one-prompt opener in the Capstone Journal. Whole-class share-out: 2–3 students.

Wednesday or Thursday — Work Block

The longest block of the week, 50–75 minutes, dedicated to the Capstone. Mini-lesson (10–15) → independent or pair work (35–50) → 5-minute close. Teacher confers with 4–6 students per block in 4-minute one-on-ones.

Friday — Showcase + Stuck

15–20-minute share. Three or four students share progress; one student shares "where I'm stuck." Class generates suggestions using the "What's working / What's confusing / One change I'd try" frame.

Daily — the Vocabulary Spine

A single-page running glossary at the back of the notebook. Students add 1–3 terms per week with a Frayer entry for "weight-bearing" terms. Tuesday/Thursday have 5-minute vocabulary openers.

Pedagogy at this grade band

- **Concrete, then abstract.** Even at 10th grade, students benefit from running real numbers (a $5,000 loan at 6% vs. 22% APR) before they generalize. Use real APRs, real state filing fees, real sales-tax rates from your jurisdiction.
- **Talk before write.** Most students at 15–16 know more than they can put on paper at first try. Pair-share before journal write.
- **Identity-aware.** A 10th grader is figuring out who they are in public — and is starting to take seriously what they might do after high school. Let them choose Capstones that signal something true to them. Coach against ventures that exclude classmates or that lean on family resources.
- **Visible thinking.** The Vocabulary Spine, Capstone Journal, and posted comparison spreadsheets make student thinking observable. That's a CASEL win as much as it is a learning-design one.

- **Less worksheet, more artifact.** The 4 Capstone Packs (Categorization, Funding, Operating Agreement, Compliance + Vision) are the year's products. Worksheets serve practice; they're not the goal.

Assessment philosophy

> **"Some of this is hard because the world's hard. The skill is knowing what's in your hands."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 10

Assess two things at every checkpoint:

1. **Did the student do the work the standard names?** Real comparison spreadsheets, real clause analyses, real premortems with specific mitigations — not pretend versions.
2. **Did they think about it?** A "what would change my call" or "what I'd ask a lawyer" line in every checkpoint. Reflection is a learning goal, not garnish.

Use the program's analytic rubrics (Rubric Bank) for the Capstone checkpoints. Use simple holistic checks (3-2-1, exit tickets) during weekly work. Avoid the trap of grading commercial viability — would this venture really work? is not the rubric. Read for evidence and reasoning quality.

A typical assessment cadence

Cadence	Form	Stakes
Daily	Exit ticket or work-block confer	Low — formative
Weekly	Capstone Journal entry	Low–medium — counts toward habit grade
Bi-weekly	Vocabulary check (10 terms)	Low — formative
End of unit	Capstone Pack with rubric	Medium-high — rubric-graded
End of year	Final Capstone Defense + Brief portfolio	Highest — full-year synthesis

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 10

"Which people, and how do you know?"

the program's spine question.

1

Pacing — week by week

The pacing below is a default. Adjust to your actual calendar (assume ~36 weeks). Each week needs roughly 90–180 instructional minutes for Cash to Company, depending on schedule density.

Unit 1 — What kind of thing is this? (Weeks 1–8)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
1	Course launch + Cash V1 ("What kind of thing is this?")	Set norms; pick Capstone categories; write a Day 1 Categorization	Day 1 Categorization filed
2	The four categories — definitions and Frayer	Frayer activity 1.2	Lock Capstone topic
3	Hobby vs. side hustle	Compare two real ventures	Categorize 1 case
4	Small business vs. startup	Cash V5 (mid-unit) on scalability	Categorize 2 cases
5	Four-Case Studio	Build the Categorization Pack	Pack drafted
6	Peer review	Anchor-paper calibration	Pack revised
7	What-would-have-to-be-true test	Activity 1.4	Pack finalized
8	**Checkpoint 1** — Categorization Pack	Pack submission + share-out	Submit Pack (graded)

Unit 2 — Money in, money out, on whose terms (Weeks 9–18)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
9	Cash V2 ("Every dollar comes with strings") + optional pivot window	Pivot decision (kept or new venture)	Confirm Capstone or pivot
10	Bootstrap and opportunity cost	Savings-vs-investment compare	Estimate bootstrap cost
11	Loan math — APR, principal, interest	Lesson 3 + APR worksheet	Compute total interest scenarios
12	Loan term sheet reading	Read sample bank term sheet	Identify 3 clauses
13	Cash V6 (mid-unit) on debt vs. equity	Concept overview	Vocab check
14	F&F money — the relationship layer	Lesson 4 + clause paraphrase	Read sample F&F note
15	Three-source comparison setup	Build spreadsheet skeleton	Spreadsheet started
16	Comparison + memo writing	Lesson 5 (Studio)	Pack drafted
17	Peer review and revision	Rubber-stamp test	Pack revised
18	**Checkpoint 2** — Funding Comparison Pack	Three-minute defenses	Submit Pack (graded)

Unit 3 — Who owns what, and how do we decide? (Weeks 19–28)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
19	Cash V3 ("Structure is a tool") + optional pivot window	Two-page case: a co-founder split that went wrong	Confirm Capstone
20	Sole prop in plain English	Activity 3.3	Map your venture
21	Operating agreement clause-by-clause	Lesson 6	Activity 3.1 + 3.2 partial
22	RACI for partnerships	Map roles for hypothetical partnership	RACI complete
23	Money handling and distributions	Cash V7 (mid-unit) on the bracelet stand	Distribution clause drafted
24	Exit clauses and buy-sell	Read 3 sample exit clauses	Exit clause drafted
25	Sole prop vs. LLC	Lesson 7	Comparison complete
26	Brand guide one-pager	Build name, tagline, palette, font, voice rule	Brand guide drafted
27	Pack assembly + peer review	Anchor-paper calibration	Pack drafted
28	**Checkpoint 3** — Operating Agreement Pack	Pack submission + share-out	Submit Pack (graded)

Unit 4 — Premortem and the month-in-review (Weeks 29–36)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
29	Cash V4 ("A premortem is cheaper than a postmortem") + optional pivot	Discussion: what kills early ventures?	Confirm Capstone
30	Premortem	Lesson 8 + sticky-note round	Top 3 risks ranked
31	Mitigation specificity	Push back on "I'll work harder"	Mitigations specific
32	Compliance categories overview	License, sales tax, ID, age, PII	Vocab check
33	Compliance map	Lesson 9	Map drafted for own Capstone
34	Vision statement + month-in-review	Activity 4.3 + 4.4	Vision drafted
35	Capstone defense prep	Storyboard the defense; rehearse pair-share	Build defense slides/poster
36	**Final Capstone Defense** + Cash V8	Public presentation + pushback capture	Deliver the defense

FAQ

Q: I'm an ELA/social studies teacher with no business or law background. Can I teach this?
A: Yes. The lesson plans script the moves; the Cash videos introduce concepts; you become the chief evidence-norm-enforcer ("which people, and how do you know? Show me the evidence."). The legal and financial content in Grade 10 is at the literacy level, not the practice level. You don't need to give legal advice — you need to teach students to read a clause, compare a funding source, and identify a compliance category.

Q: A student wants to actually form an LLC for their Capstone. A: Coach toward the educational frame: "The Capstone is educational. If you and your family decide to form one for real, that's a family decision involving a real lawyer and a real accountant — outside this curriculum." Don't help them file. Don't tell them not to file. Stay in the educational lane. The Grade 12 year is the better place for real-launch decisions.

Q: A student volunteers that their family has gone through a small-business bankruptcy.
A: Listen briefly, validate, redirect to the school counselor if it's heavy. Don't probe. Don't use

the disclosure as a teaching moment. Re-anchor the class on hypothetical examples for the rest of the unit.

Q: We don't have spreadsheet access in my classroom. A: The funding comparison can be done by hand using the worksheet template. It's slower but the math is the same. The Cash videos and lesson plans don't require digital tools. Print-first by design.

Q: My students don't have stable internet at home. A: Run the curriculum print-first. The Cash videos have transcripts; the operating agreement, premortem, compliance map, and brand guide templates are 1-pagers; the Capstone Journal is a notebook, not an app. Optional digital extensions are explicitly optional.

Q: A student wants to do a venture that involves age-restricted products (alcohol, tobacco, vaping accessories, supplements). A: Use the Week 9 or Week 19 pivot window. Most teen ventures should avoid age-restricted categories on legal and ethical grounds. Coach toward an adjacent venture that captures their interest without the regulatory exposure. Document the conversation; loop in the parent guide if relevant.

Q: How do I assess fairly when students choose different ventures (some real, some hypothetical)? A: The rubrics are content-agnostic. They measure categorization quality, comparison rigor, agreement clarity, premortem honesty, and compliance literacy — not how cool or scalable the venture is. A hypothetical T-shirt venture and a real online tutoring venture can both score 4s if the work is rigorous.

Q: What if a student wants to talk about real family money problems triggered by these lessons? A: Refer to the school counselor. Don't try to handle it inside the lesson. The curriculum is designed to leave private home finance off the table; if a student volunteers something heavy, listen briefly, validate, and route appropriately.

Q: Do I need to give grades on the Cash videos? A: No. The Cash videos are concept anchors. Use them for opening discussions and reflection prompts. The Capstone checkpoints carry the grade weight.

Q: What's the minimum I can do if I'm out of time some weeks? A: Protect the long Wednesday/Thursday Work Block. Skip Monday or Friday before you skip the Work Block. The Capstone is the spine; everything else is helpful but not load-bearing.

Q: Should I bring in a guest attorney or accountant? A: Optional but high-value if available. A 30-minute Q&A with a real attorney (or law student) in Unit 3, and with a real CPA (or accounting student) in Unit 2, demonstrates the line between literacy and advice. If you do this, brief the guest: "We're teaching the categories and tradeoffs, not making student-specific recommendations."

Common pitfalls

> **“Most adults skip this step. You won't.”**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 10

- **The "Cash said form an LLC" trap.** Cash never tells a student what to do. If a student writes that, redirect: "What does Cash actually say? Cash asks. You decide. The decision belongs to you and your family — not to a curriculum."
- **The vague comparison.** A student writes "the loan is bad because it has interest." Push back: bad compared to what? The comparison only works against a named alternative with quantified tradeoffs. Require numbers.
- **The fake premortem.** A student lists 3 generic risks ("not enough customers, not enough money, not enough time") with vague mitigations ("I'll work harder"). Push back: specific, named risks with specific, named mitigations. "I'll secure a customer pool by Week 2 by interviewing 5 people" — not "I'll get more customers."
- **The compliance shrug.** A student writes "compliance doesn't apply — I'm too small." Surface the asymmetry: small ventures still have sales-tax obligations in most states, still have license requirements in most cities, still have PII obligations if they collect any user data. Compliance is rarely zero.
- **The defense that's a sales pitch.** The final defense is analytical and reflective, not enthusiastic. Coach toward evidence and reasoning, not Shark-Tank energy. The pushback capture is the real measure of growth.
- **Asking about family money.** The most common slip in financial education. Re-read the differentiation guide and the Curriculum Book sensitivity section before designing any new activity. Default to hypothetical scenarios. "For a sample $3,000 venture" is the year's framing.

Working with the Cash mascot

Cash is a mascot, not a teacher. Do not let students treat Cash's word as authority — Cash poses questions; students answer them in evidence. If a student says "Cash said form an LLC," redirect: "Cash doesn't tell you what to do. What's your evidence? What's the tradeoff?"

For voice and personality of Cash at this grade band, see the Cash Mascot Style Guide. Bottom line: Cash at 9-12 builds multi-sentence arguments, uses words like unit economics, runway, premortem, segmentation, MVP, and is willing to name systemic factors directly.

Cash never promises wealth, never says "everyone can be rich," never says "easy money," never says "boss up," and never says "amazing." See style guide for the full forbidden list.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 10

"Most adults skip this step. You won't."

the band's working assumption.

2

Working with parents and caregivers

The Parent Guide is sent home in Week 1 with a brief overview and four optional conversation starters (one per quarter). The biggest parent question is: "is my kid going to be asked to invest real money or sign anything?" Answer: no. Capstones are educational; any real-money or real-formation decisions are family decisions and outside the curriculum.

Some parents will arrive eager — they may run businesses themselves, or want to use the curriculum as a launchpad. Welcome the engagement; hold the line on the educational frame. Parents who want their student to launch real ventures should plan for that in Grade 12 (the launch-ready year).

Some parents will arrive nervous — they may worry the curriculum is pushing their kid toward entrepreneurship as a career path. The honest answer: it isn't. Cash to Company makes one promise — that students who move through the program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepreneurship, no matter what they end up doing for a living. The program does not promise wealth or success. It promises clarity.

A teacher self-check at end of year

> **“Don't make up a winner. Decide what to test next.”**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 10

Did most of my students this year:

- Categorize at least 4 ventures with evidence? (Yes/No)
- Build a funding comparison spreadsheet with real APR math? (Yes/No)
- Read and paraphrase 3 clauses of an operating agreement? (Yes/No)
- Build a 1-page brand guide and defend each choice? (Yes/No)
- Conduct a premortem with 3 ranked risks and specific mitigations? (Yes/No)
- Map their venture against 5 compliance categories? (Yes/No)
- Deliver a 5-minute defense with captured pushback? (Yes/No)

If five of those seven are yes, the year worked. If fewer, look at which routine slipped — usually the long Work Block.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Differentiation deep moves (Grade 10)

Advanced learners — three named extensions

1. **Multi-state structure analysis.** For students who finish the LLC-vs-sole-prop work fast: compare the registration cost and tax treatment in 3 states (their state + 2 others). Real founders deal with this; it's a clean extension.
2. **Premortem 2.0.** Beyond top-3 risks, advanced students rank by severity × probability and build a mitigation plan for top 5.
3. **The "I am declining to launch" memo.** A student writes a memo declining to launch their own Capstone, with reasons. Forces honesty; some real ventures should not happen.

ELL deep moves

- **Term-sheet glossary in two languages.** Principal, interest, default, equity, profit-share — each in English + home language.
- **Operating-agreement template with one clause per page.** Reduces overwhelm.
- **Cognate-rich brand vocabulary.** Marca, paleta, tipografía.

IEP/504 deep moves

- **Pre-built sole-prop-vs-LLC comparison spreadsheet.** Student fills in the matrix; computer does the totaling.
- **Premortem in stem form.** "This venture failed because __." Five sentence stems pre-printed.
- **Brand guide template, one box per page.** Logo box, color box, font box, voice box, tagline box.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Cash Never Says (Teacher Reference Card)

Cash never says: "Amazing!" / "Crushing it!" / "Boss up" / "Get that bag" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Financial freedom" / "Just believe" / "Side hustle" (use "side venture") / wealth-flexing language / anything implying wealth is mindset/hustle / anything implying low-income or unbanked families are at fault.

Cash always asks: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "What did they actually say?" / "Whats the evidence?" / "What would have to be true for you to be right/wrong?"

Teacher mirror: Replace "great job!" with "okay, thats specific — whats the evidence?"

Cashs three signature physical moves: (1) **Notebook Tilt**; (2) **Two-Finger Tap**; (3) **Slow Lean**.

ENDNOTES & STANDARDS

Citations and alignment

Grade 10 cites 3-6 standards across CCSS, Jump$tart, CEE, CASEL, and C3 frameworks. Detailed alignment lives in the master Standards Alignment Map.

1. **Jump$tart Coalition Personal Finance Standards (2021 ed.).** Spending and Saving; Credit and Debt; Employment and Income; Investing; Risk Management and Insurance; Financial Decision Making.
2. **Council for Economic Education (CEE).** Voluntary National Content Standards in Economics.
3. **CCSS-ELA, Grades 11-12.** W.11-12.1, W.11-12.4, SL.11-12.1, SL.11-12.4, RST.11-12.7.
4. **CCSS-Math.** N-Q.1-3 (Reasoning with Quantities), S-IC (Statistics & Inferences), F-IF (Functions), MP.4 (Modeling).
5. **CASEL Core Competencies.** Self-Awareness, Self-Management, Social Awareness, Relationship Skills, Responsible Decision-Making.
6. **C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards.** Dimension 2 (Economics, Civics) at the high-school grade band.
7. **NGSS-ETS Engineering Practices.** ETS1 (Engineering Design) for the test-and-iterate spine of the year.
8. **Cash to Company Master Scope & Sequence.** 13 grades x 8 strands x 36 weeks; outcomes quoted verbatim from _master/00_Master_Scope_and_Sequence.md.
9. **Cash Mascot Style Guide.** 9-12 voice rules: multi-sentence arguments; vocabulary includes unit economics, runway, premortem, MVP; never flatters, never promises wealth.
10. **Sensitivity protocol.** No probing of family finances; financial scenarios framed as hypothetical for a sample household, business, or scenario.

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move t
program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepren
matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We pro

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> **- CASH, GRADE 10**

For educational use. This curriculum is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).